BindLens Quick guide

Your documents, bound into books - read, mark, write, find. Your files stay where they are.

1 Install it (once)

- Install **Python** from python.org - tick “Add python.exe to PATH”.
- Right-click **BindLens.zip** › **Extract All**, then double-click **Install.bat**. Open BindLens with its **icon on your desktop**.
- **New version:** drop the new zip on BindLens (or run Install.bat again). Your books, marks and settings stay.

2 Make your books

- Click **+**: **Add a folder** - it becomes a **book**, all its documents one after another - or **Add documents** (each one a book). PDF, Word, Excel, pictures... Nothing is copied; new files appear by themselves (missing one? Help › **Check my folders**). Moved or renamed a folder? BindLens finds it and follows it (or click **Find it...**).
- Folders inside it become **sub-books**. Right-click a book for **New sub-book...**, **Add files...**, **Add a folder from your computer as a sub-book...**, **Rename...**.
- The icons on the left are your books: click one to open it, **drag** it to change the order. Click it **3 times** to change its icon, colour and text (e.g. 2028, W38). The small refresh arrow on a book reads its folder again. **Ctrl+L** shows all your books.
- Right-click a file in the list: **Status** (Pending, Checked, Signed, Done...), **Rename file** (F2), **Convert to PDF** (Word, Excel... to add marks).

3 Read

- Scroll through the whole book like one long document.
- The bar at the bottom: page number, zoom, fit width / fit page. **Ctrl + mouse wheel** zooms - the page stays in the middle; zoom **out** and more pages appear beside it, little by little: click one to open it.
- Beside the page: on the left the **map of the book** - a little **shelf** (how many documents, how far you have read; click a book on it), its documents and the **chapters** of the one you are reading (click one to go there) - on the right a **clock**, the date and your next deadline.
- **Read** button (F6): a quiet **reading mode** - the top bar shows what you read, **Choose**, **Print** and **Exit**. **Pictures** open as a framed gallery; Read shows them big, with an **effect**. Double-click a **video** to play it.
- BindLens opens where you left off. **F11** full screen · **F9** library panel.

4 Mark your PDFs - saved in the original file

- **Select text**: a small bar appears - a colour highlights it, **U** underlines, **S** strikes through, **Note** adds a note.
- Tools at the top: **Pen** · **Text** (click and type on the page) · **Sticky note** · **Shapes** (colours and effects: gradient, glossy, glow, 3D) · **Stamp** (also **ticks and crosses**) · **Eraser** - also a **White box** or **White brush** to hide the PDF's own text · colour · undo / redo.
- Click a mark to **move** it, drag its corner to **resize**, the round handle to **turn** it. Double-click to edit. **Delete** removes it. **Ctrl+Z** / **Ctrl+Y** undo, redo.
- **Ctrl+E**: click a line of the PDF's own text and change it - same font, size and colour, or change them in the small bar. **Shift+Enter** keeps it as a mark you can take off later - on **scans** too.
- Everything is saved **inside the original PDF** - one file, no copies - and every mark can be taken off again.

5 Write and arrange pages

- The **page +** button writes a new page, like a simple Word: text, tables, pictures, and templates (letter, meeting notes, to-do list, invoice, planner...). **Ctrl+S** saves. File › **New document...**: a new PDF.
- **Pages** menu: add pages from another PDF, turn, move, delete, save pages as a new PDF, split a file, remind me about this page. A deleted page goes to **Pages › Deleted pages...** - put it back any time.
- **Scan and add** (File menu): a scanner, the camera or phone photos (iPhone too) - each page cut out, straightened (even photographed at an angle), cleaned and put in the book, its text read so you can search it.

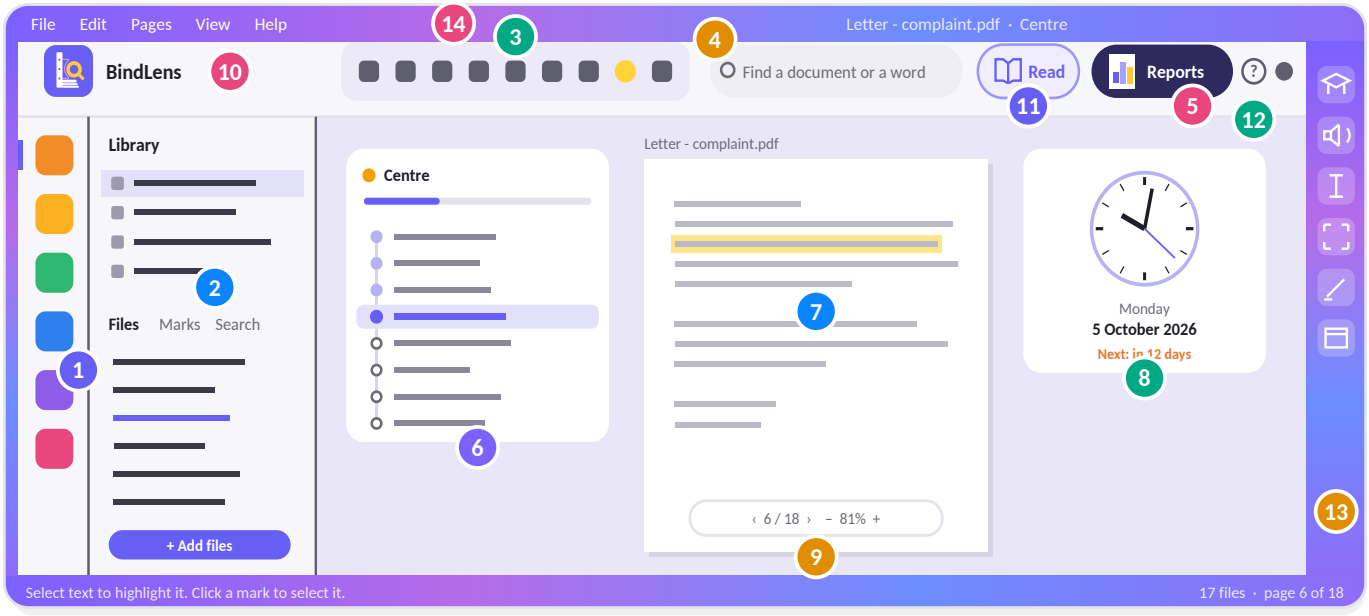
6 Find

- The **search box** at the top: type part of a document's name - it doesn't have to be exact (*week 38*, *wk38*, *invoce march*) - and click it to open it. Or search the words in this book or in all your books.
- **Ctrl+F** this book · **Ctrl+K** everywhere: document names, or words inside the documents.

8 Share

- The **printer** at the top (**Ctrl+P**): pages, copies, size on the paper (fit, 100%, any %), sides, colour - straight to your printer. **File** menu: **Send by email...** · **Read-only copy...** · **Save the whole book as one PDF...**

The window at a glance



1. **Your books** - click one to open it; click it 3 times to change its icon
2. **Library panel** - books, sub-books and the files of the open book
3. **Tools** - select, pen, text, sticky note, shapes, stamp, eraser, colour, undo
4. **Search box** - a document by its name, or a word inside
5. **Reports** - emails, names, rows of tables, summaries, charts…
6. **Map of the book** - where you are; click a document to go there
7. **Your pages** - scroll through the book; select text to mark it
8. **Clock** - the date and your next deadline (click to change it)
9. **Page bar** - page number, zoom, fit width / page
10. **Logo** - Personalise, Settings, all my books, help
11. **Read** - reading mode: pages, contents and a clock (F6)
12. **?** - how BindLens works, in one short page (F1)
13. **Quick bar** - study, read aloud, scan… (right-click it)
14. **Frame** - one ring: top bar, tips, tools; colours in Personalise

7 Reports - the data you need, in seconds

- Click **Reports** (or **Ctrl+R**). **Essentials** first: **Contacts**, **Expiry dates**, **Invoices & money** (each invoice's own total, what is overdue), **Tables** (rows and columns as they are), **Find**, **A person**, **Marks**, **Charts**. More below: extract data, text, documents, dates, data quality.
- Tick only what you want in it - e.g. for Emails: the person, the document, the page. Forms and **scanned pages** are read too. Choose where to look (**Look in**) › **Create report**.
- You see it first: double-click a row to open its page. Then **save as PDF, Word or Excel**, or copy it.
- Names, emails and phones are found by **what each column holds** - whatever the titles say - and every link says **how sure** BindLens is. Charts say in a sentence what they show.
- Or ask in your own words: *Mary Ryan - phone, email · total amount per month*.

Everything stays on your computer: no account, nothing is sent anywhere (only the photo gallery downloads pictures). Your books and settings are kept in **%APPDATA%\BindLens**. Help › **Shortcuts** shows this again.

9 Make it yours

- Click the **logo** › **Personalise**: theme, colours, backgrounds (woods, marble, linen, photos, calm moving skies), the clock and a **calendar** card (drag it anywhere; click a day to add a note).
- **The quick bar** on the right: **Study** (Ctrl+B - summary sheet, review cards), **Read aloud** (Ctrl+U; right-click a page: from here), Scan and add… Right-click it to choose. The **frame**, **Home** and **Reading mode** (Home: a **bookcase**, a **filing cabinet**…): in Personalise.
- **Settings** (**Ctrl+,**) · File › **Lock with a PIN** (4 digits) - or lock one book (right-click it) · **?** (F1): a short guide.

10 Shortcuts

Ctrl+K	Find anywhere	Ctrl+R	Reports
Ctrl+F	Find in this book	F6	Reading mode
Ctrl+H	Home	Ctrl+E	Edit the text
Ctrl+U	Read aloud	Ctrl+B	Study
Ctrl+L	All my books	F11	Full screen
Ctrl+,	Settings	Ctrl+P	Print